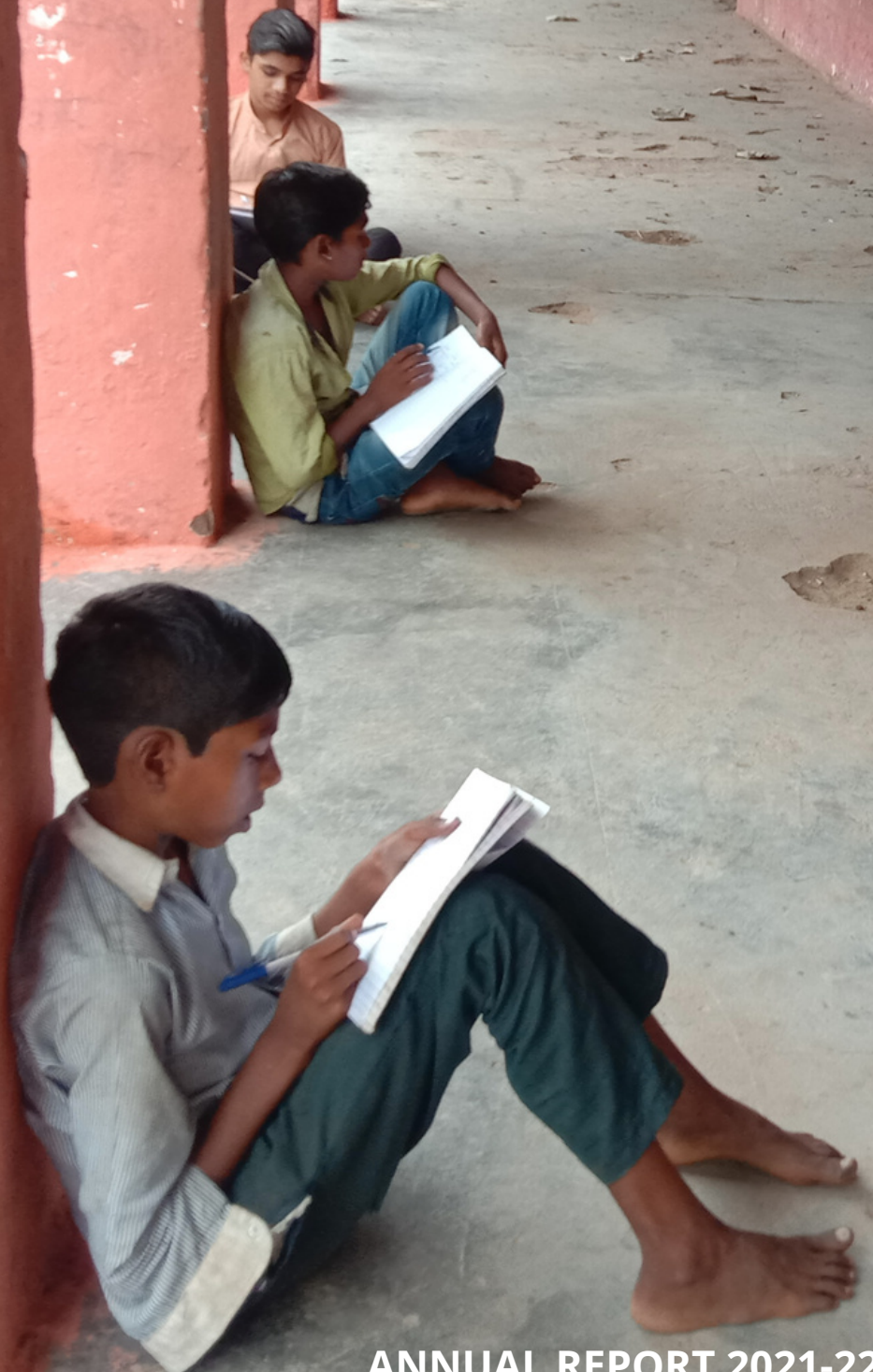




kshamtalaya

Rebuild. Learn. Grow



ANNUAL REPORT 2021-22

The years' contrasts and contradictions, however, did not prevent the organizational vision of supporting children in realizing their true potential through meaningful, relevant, and compassionate education. With a strong belief that a pandemic cannot stop children from learning, this was demonstrated by the teams across locations in all resilience, trust, and commitment, rooted in compassion towards the communities and children.

Executive Summary

The second wave of the COVID 19 pandemic had increased the uncertainty of the reopening of schools. This brought in and created opportunities to think, identify and work through innovative ways to keep the children engaged with their learning processes and to ensure the community's participation in the same. We were able to identify a blended approach to facilitate a community-driven process toward ensuring continuity of learning.

The Hamlet Learning circles which were being facilitated by the iDiscover Fellows saw a discontinuity, due to the lockdown imposed. The infection of the second wave had reached the smaller communities and opened up other adversities. While virtual learning was possible in a very small percentage, it encouraged the participation of many young volunteers from the communities, to support and anchor children's learning. In Delhi, the situation saw an increased and larger adaptation of the virtual

means of learning and engagement.

While our agenda has been to ensure that children realize their potential through meaningful, relevant, and compassionate education, it was also important for us to stand by the communities in times of distress. These times of need and response have also provided an opportunity not only to facilitate support but also to build and strengthen authentic connections with the communities. It helped us paint a clearer picture of the scenario and to empathize with the suffering of the people.

The previous quarter saw a shift from virtual to in-person sessions, from COVID responsive to school preparedness, which was a plethora of experiences and learning. The Hamlet Learning Circles continued to function within the communities and were also gifted with Learning Festivals. With a reduction in the peak of the second wave, the focus shifted

gradually towards working closely with the teachers, community, and governance to support children's learning. This also meant, ensuring and supporting teachers' emotional and mental well-being, for which a state-level partnership opened the pathways to facilitate the same at a larger scale and level, through our flagship program *Hausla*.

While the younger grades were unclear of starting to go to school, the secondary grades witnessed a readiness to be welcomed back to the school and classrooms. While this took time, it also paved the way to understand the status of children's learning through the customary ASER assessments.

In Delhi, with the waves of the pandemic also seeming to reduce, it gave us opportunities to work closely with the teachers and school leadership to prepare the schools and classrooms to feel welcoming for the children who have been away from these learning spaces for more than a year.

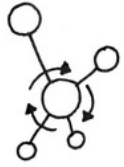
The last quarter witnessed two extremes of the school reopening phases amidst the ongoing COVID 19 pandemic. While the schools reopened in Rajasthan, and the children were returning to schools; In Delhi, the schools reopened-witnessed children and teachers back in the now colorful learning spaces-and then, had to be closed down due to increasing levels of pollution. Interestingly, the changed timing of school hours in Rajasthan led to challenges and changes in the process of the Fale Fale Shiksha Muhim program, which aims to support children with their foundational learning skills through peer, local, and community support.

These contrasts and contradictions, however, did not prevent the organizational vision of supporting children in realizing their true potential through meaningful, relevant, and compassionate education. With a strong belief that a pandemic cannot stop children from learning, this was demonstrated by the teams across locations in all resilience, trust, and commitment, rooted in compassion towards the communities and children.

VISION

All children will realise their true potential through meaningful, relevant and compassionate education.

GOALS & OBJECTIVES



1. Bring Systemic Change from Ground

Bring cluster level systemic change in schools in areas of holistic learning and governance



2. Develop Model Centers of Excellence

Create centers of excellence through whole school transformation models



3. Consolidate Grassroot Educators

Developing a grassroots movement of proactive and skilled educators/professionals



4. Encourage Dialogue Culture and Curate Conversations

Develop a culture of dialogue/samvaad around learning and governance in the communities

OUR CORE VALUES



Compassion



Innovation



Excellence



Trust



Freedom with
Responsibility

OUR OUTREACH



16023

Children
through direct
engagement



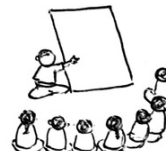
11810

Community
members



2359

Teachers &
Educators



151

Facilitators



1,20,000+

Children
through virtual
engagement



519

Out-of-school
Children



134

Learning
Festivals



39

Panchayats



42

Schools



200+

Volunteers



98

PRI Members

Our Programs



Kshamtalaya's core aim has been to ensure every child and young adult has equal chance of succeeding in life irrespective of the circumstances they are born with. The aim is to build creative confidence, entrepreneurial mindset and resilience through our different programs.

The key focus is to support schools and communities to build collective leadership and drive the agenda of learning together. The three core areas of our intervention have been -

- Improving governance at the last mile
- Learning Environment and outcomes
- Well-being.

THE PROGRAMS

- C.E.L.L (Cluster Excellence Learning Labs)
- Learning Festivals
- Project Diganth
- Fale Fale Shiksha Muhim
- Whole School Transformation
- Family Champions Program
- Community Libraries

**“Children
must be
taught how to
think, not
what to
think.”**

- MARGARET MEAD

RAJASTHAN

Cluster Excellence Learning Labs (C.E.L.L)



AN OVERVIEW

The Cluster Excellence Learning Labs aim to demonstrate holistic learning and smart governance in all the schools of a cluster.

Striving towards creating a robust system of excellence, the intervention focuses on creating a model center of excellence in each school by bringing excellence in Learning, wellbeing and Governance.

Each school is supported through weekly coaching and demonstration on integrated learning social, emotional, ethical learning and community leadership.

This high-intensity demonstration is orchestrated by the iDiscover Fellows.

THE SHIFT

The new operational cycle started with a setback of the second wave resurfacing the world in a more lethal way than before and taking away all the hopes of schools getting open with it. This time the community spread was very high.

KEY OBJECTIVES

- Retention of students connected to schools.
- Improved Foundational learning outcomes and life skills of primary students
- Building capacity of teachers around integrated pedagogies and adopting well-being practices
- Strengthening community's engagement to ensure effective governance and institutional efficiency
- Building a cohort of regional leaders who are committed to lead educational movement



2316

Children



750+

Parents



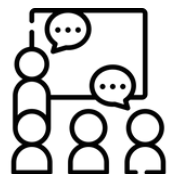
75

Teachers



600+

SMC
Members



20

Fellows



40

Schools



11

Panchayats

Children



HAMLET LEARNING CIRCLES

During the lethal second wave when the school again went into lockdown, there was a continued effort to keep children connected with the learning process. With onboarding a new batch of fellows, we continued the 40 Hamlet learning circles in all our partner communities. We were able to engage 1864 children with 2797 integrated learning sessions in the first six months of the operational cycle. Parents appreciated the efforts made by the fellows in supporting children in their education.

SCHOOL BASED LEARNING ENGAGEMENT

As soon as the schools reopened, the sessions started taking place in schools. We conducted 2964 sessions in 40 schools from October to March 2023. We were able to reach 2316 children in the entire year with integrated learning sessions on different themes and Exploring kindness in SEE learning.

LEARNING FESTIVALS

Conducted 107 learning festivals with children on learning mediums of art integrations,

- *67% of children have shown positive shift in their Hindi reading and more than 65% of the children have shown improvement in their Math ability out of a sample of 1903 children.*
- *After conducting baseline and end line with a sample of 1690 children we found that around 44% of children showed a positive shift in their perspective-taking/empathy, communicating their feelings and curiosity.*

Teachers



HAUSLA, MENTAL WELLBEING PROGRAM

The Pandemic increased the challenges of teachers working already in difficult geographies. Considering the mental and emotional states of teachers we conducted Hausla with all direct teachers and also invited the rest of the teachers in schools to join. 32 teachers completed their journey of well-being with Hausla Program and 35 of them participated in the process.

TEACHER WORKSHOP

We were able to engage more than 90% of our 75 teachers through quarterly workshops. The major objective of these workshops was to build a shared vision for student support and co-plan to be able to engage a maximum number of students.

NODAL MEETINGS

We also ensured regular engagement with teachers through monthly nodal meetings where we could discuss the most pertinent challenges of teachers and devise strategies to support school processes.

The consistent engagement with teachers added a lot of value in the connection building with teachers in building vision and co-planning the reach and engagement with the children

Community Participation



SMC WORKSHOP

We conducted 97 SMC workshops this year with 40 schools with an average attendance of 8-9 members at each meeting. The response of SMCs had been really supportive in terms of building accountability toward the proper functioning of schools.

PARENTS-TEACHER MEETING

Community's participation was the most crucial element that could enable us to engage with children without any obstacles. Their trust and continuous support encourage us to do more for our children. We conducted more than 200 monthly meetings this year with an average turnout of 409 parents.

ENGAGEMENTS WITH SARPANCH AND WARD PANCH

Quarterly workshops were conducted with PRI members to build leadership in the Sarpanch and Ward Panch by building awareness on the fundamental rights of any citizen, about systems and processes to make their panchayat Bal Mitra Panchayat and also to ensure a consistent support system for the schools and for children.

SMC members of GUPS Anjani, Kotra donated their land to the school after understanding the need for space for children to learn and also collected money to arrange for floor mats for children.

The challenge of poor governance in the functioning of schools as per their scheduled time due to the lack of any process to ensure the accountability of teachers was addressed by the community in GPS Kharon ki Khejdi and GPS Degrifala. It happened when the fellow took a step to engage with different stakeholders to establish this as a pertinent issue for communities to engage with to solve this problem that further leads to more sustainable impact.

Regional Leaders- Fellows

CAPABILITY DEVELOPMENT

This year was full of growth for fellows. Weekly capacity building sessions along with mid year bootcamp, Kshamta Utsav supported fellows in bringing personal as well as professional growth.

Fellows build domain expertise and also were supported with sessions on Art of questions, Self compassion, Art based Integration, Documentation through photos and story telling, Vision to action articulation and so on. They learnt the art of learner centered facilitation through Kshamta Utsav and weekly sessions.

OPPORTUNITY

This year was full of testing and rewarding opportunities for fellows. Second wave of pandemic tested their resilience when they were struggling to bring their children together.

Apart from that regular field support, weekly problem solving debriefs, Large group meetings, planning an exhibition as part of the consolidation process and most of all one to one provided fellows with the opportunity to rebuild, learn and grow.

MOTIVATION

One to one support system, purpose building, created space for fellows to build intrinsic motivation.

Constant habit and culture reviews, Reflections on enablers and barriers, encouragement and difficult conversations all of this supported in building extrinsic Motivation for fellows.

- *Radha and Amrit, two iDiscover fellows from the present batch, were felicitated on 15th August by the block level Government functionaries for their exceptional contribution in supporting children's learning during the pandemic and standing with the community during difficult times. It was an inspirational moment for the entire cohort and the local community members to aspire and lead.*
- *Fellow Jagdish's efforts were appreciated by PEEO of Mandwa school during "KishoriMela" conducted in September month.*
- *GSSS Mandwa, Kotda, Rajasthan received a prestigious recognition of being under top 100 schools in the world in T4 World education week.*

"I see opportunities during a crisis too" marks Mohit ji, the PEEO of Mandwa senior secondary school. His contributions ever since his appointment in the year 2019 has only been demonstrating progress and the willingness and belief to bring a change.

The latest facelift that the school has got which has special contribution from a local painter and Mohit ji himself has brought laurels to this village. Community members walking past the school now cannot miss this "train-like" building which is getting prepared to welcome the students if we are expecting the schools to open at least for the senior secondary students.

The journey is an example of how a government school adopted a collaborative approach towards infrastructural improvement. With donations from the local community members, inviting a local painter to transform the dull walls into imaginative ones and prioritizing children's safety and hygiene Mandwa Senior Secondary school has achieved what no school has been able to in the Kotda Block.

Mohit sir shares that this wouldn't have been possible without the support from the community and Kshamtalaya's efforts in improving the learning outcomes of students in the school. He acknowledged the contributions of everyone responsible and truly believes that change is not possible by one person alone, it can only happen when the whole community comes together.

Consistent engagement with teachers, community, the entire ecosystem and with the collective efforts of fellows and the system, we could not only bring back 96% of the children to school once they reopened after one and a half years

“Tell me and I forget, teach me and I may remember, involve me and I learn.”

- BENJAMIN FRANKLIN

Learning Festivals



AN OVERVIEW

The Learning Festivals are a series of experiential learning workshops designed in the form of a progression of activities taking children from exploration to creation. The 6-day format builds in students' creative confidence by giving opportunities to experiment, collaborate, try new things and learn by doing. The last day is a culmination of sharing and celebrating what the students have learnt and created through an exhibition which is attended by the parents, teachers, community members and local governance leaders.

THE SHIFT

While the schools were closed due to the ongoing pandemic, it was also important to ensure joyful learning spaces for children in their communities and to increase the participation of parents, community members, and the local governance towards children's learning processes.

KEY OBJECTIVES

- Create Child-Friendly Learning Spaces
- Demonstrate value of Encouragement and Creative Confidence
- Empower Learners to take Initiative and Responsibility
- Facilitate Peer Learning/Cross Learning
- Promote Self Expression



3500

Children



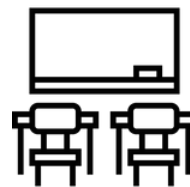
1000+

Community
Members



134

Learning
Festivals



66

Schools



14

Panchayats



2

Blocks



131

Volunteers & Fellows
Trained

A Leader in the Making

The LF provides opportunities to students to demonstrate their inner leadership skills wherein by design one student each day on a rotation basis becomes the group leader. For Aasha Kumari, this has been a way to find her inner potential to lead! our volunteer Partharam writes this story from Umri Paadar, a remote village from the Juna Paadar panchayat. During the LFs 18 drop-out students were seen taking part in the studio activities.

During the first day of LF the facilitator observes that not all children from the community have come. Making the students also part of the mission he shared how can we bring more of our friends and participate in this joyous process of learning.

Aasha Kumari took up this challenge and everyday after LF would meet the children in and around her community who do not attend school. On one of the days, the volunteer assisted her and he found her sharing in this manner, "in school these days they are teaching us puppet making, theatre, songs and games - why don't you come I am enjoying it and am sure even you will." he found that she was advocating not only for her studio but for the rest of the studios or for the cause of the Learning Festivals too. She managed to bring 2-3 such children and induct them into the LFs processes.

**“The secret in
education lies
in respecting
the student.”**

- RALPH WALDO EMERSON

Project Diganth



AN OVERVIEW

Kshamtalaya, Jatan Sansthan and Educate for Life have partnered to support two rural secondary schools in Jhed and Mandwa, Kotra-Rajasthan.

The program aims at supporting students of a senior secondary school in completing their school education and transitioning into life beyond school. Together, we are working on establishing well-functioning systems to inspire best practices in other schools in the area. Students at these schools are provided disciplined academic support, individual guidance, digital access and agency, exposure to working ecosystems and career orientation for an easy transition into life after school as socially and economically active adults.

THE SHIFT

Two sub teams were formed - Virtual Support Team and Field Support Team. The Virtual support team reached out to students through audio, video and zoom calls. The field support team facilitated learning circles in the hamlets.

KEY OBJECTIVES

- Support children in developing age appropriate non-academic competencies
- Initiate Career Orientation
- Curating Resources and Facilitating Mentorship
- Enable school leadership for efficient school governance
- Strengthening all stakeholders- local communities and the parents in building a positive attitude towards schooling and learning.



329

Children



6

Teachers



2

Schools



2

Panchayats

Children



ACADEMIC SUPPORT AND PERSONALIZED SUPPORT

329 students from grade 8 to grade 12 of GSSS Mandwa and GSSS Jhed received academic support from 6 facilitators in their respective academic areas including Math, Science, Political Science, Geography, Hindi etc. Students were also supported on one to one basis considering the diverse needs of the students.

CAREER PATHWAYS AND ASPIRATION

The intervention included integrated sessions on career awareness with students. 70% of the students got registered on Rajiv Gandhi Career Awareness portal

DIGITAL LITERACY SUPPORT

Students of both the schools were supported with sessions on Digital literacy building office skills. In Mandwa the ICT lab was provided by the administration and in Jhed the computer lab was setup by Diganth program by setting up 13 chrome books

SUMMER CAMP

In the month of May the summer school program was organised for the students of jhed and mandwa school from 7th to 30th May 2022 for the first time. With an objective to introduce and expose the students to sports, computer, drama sessions.

69% and 65% of students passed and transitioned from 10th Grade board exams from Jhed and Mandwa schools respectively, whereas 94% and 91% in grade 12.

Ecosystem of children



TEACHER SUPPORT

Ensuring academic support to teachers along with establishing discipline in school, taking extra classes and supporting students in the absence of the teachers. Support teachers in administrative work as well.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Consistent home visits to students to build awareness in parents to support their children accordingly and also identifying bright spots in community to influence the regularity of students. Meetings with Sarpanch was also conducted to increase their participation in school processes and provide necessary support to schools in creating a healthy, hygienic and conducive environment for students to learn

Impact of such support systems

**“The best
teacher of
children, in
brief, is one
who is
essentially
childlike.”**

- H.L.MENCKEN

Fale Fale Shiksha Muhim



AN OVERVIEW

The objective of this program is to identify adolescents from the community, studying in school, build their capacities on aspects of civic awareness, digital literacy, pedagogy, career support. These adolescents or Kshamta Saathis will go on to work with younger children in their communities, imparting learning based on the school curriculum.

THE SHIFT

In continuity, 200 Kshamta Saathis were onboarded and the interventions shifted to in-person interactions. A new program lead for the block of Kotra was also identified, which resulted in increased engagement with the CMs in the block and their Kshamta Saathis.

KEY OBJECTIVES

- To support the local youth by building their capacities on 21st century skills.
- To create peer learning environments in communities.
- To introduce and provide various career opportunities to the youth of the communities.



2620

Children



200+

Kshamta
Sathi



120

Community
ambassadors



9

Community
Mobilizer



28

Panchayats

Children



NEIGHBOURHOOD LEARNING CIRCLES-

2620 children were engaged in cumulatively more than 10500 sessions on building foundational literacy and numeracy through Integrated Audio learning program played on the speaker. Children in these neighborhood learning circles experienced joyful learning through their neighborhood friends, brothers and sisters. All the parents appreciated Kshamta Sathis for supporting their children.

Kshamta Sathi



KSHAMTA SATHI INDUCTION

The CMs held an induction program for the KS to orient them

- of their roles and responsibilities and
- providing a sneak-peak on what they are going to learn during the weekly workshops.

Another important task carried out by CMs during this workshop was to give them instructions on how to use the bluetooth speakers, how to take care of it while charging and how do they navigate to listen to stories loaded in it

KSHAMTA SATHI CAREER BOOTCAMP

95% Kshamta Sathi attended the career bootcamp organized to provide them with career guidance and build an awareness around various career opportunities and the process of pursuing these paths. This event created wonderful energy in Kshamta Sathi and the entire team as it was one of its kind opportunity for children explore their interest areas, learn about different occupations and build connections.

WEEKLY THEMATIC WORKSHOPS

200+ Kshamta Sathi (Student Volunteers) were supported through 274 weekly workshops. out of which 196 Kshamta Sathi sustained till the end.

The objectives of these workshops are to ensure :

1. to build their capacity on Play-based pedagogy to disseminate FNL and Well-being content
2. To provide inputs on how to run the learning circles effectively
3. To build their capacity on the life skills through Ultimate Frisbee and Team building sessions
4. To build their capacity on facilitation with Children in the Learning Circle.

COMMUNITY LED FRISBEE TOURNAMENT

A community led frisbee tournament was organized in both the blocks for Kshamta Sathis to bridge the gender gap, cultivate life skills, build a team spirit in Kshamta Sathis.

STORY

Mali, who studies in 12 th class, lives in juda panchayat, Kotda. When she became a Kshamta Saathi, often one would observe that she always participated in all workshops but never speaks to anyone and was very less expressive.

When she attended the BOOT camp, she got exposure of journalism from the media studio. This was facilitated by a local youth Adivasi Vinod who runs a local news channel called Kotda Times. The very next day she is seen taking interview all over the camp and asking questions to everyone and after the camp she got connected with Vinod, who then went on take her to another local event where she covered the event and did successfully completed the internship with him. Vinod also applauded her confidence and ability to form questions and ask the interviewees. When Mali discovered what she loves, she started expressing her true potential!

[illegible]

The National Education Policy 2020 brought transformative ideas on strengthening elementary education and touched upon aspects of integrating learning areas which were categorized into different disciplines - curricular and extracurriculars. With the NEP 2020 emphasizing the importance of the mental and emotional health of children, an opportunity to hold a conversation on the integration of practices and aspects of wellbeing in the state curricular frameworks was created. This opened up avenues for Kshamtalaya to collaborate with the Government of education to demonstrate a systemic transformation model across Udaipur.

Based on the 5 years of ground experience and expertise in Content Development & Capacity Building, Kshamtalaya received blanket permission to work with all the blocks of the Udaipur district in connecting children with quality education, building the capacity of teachers in Integrated Pedagogy and supporting them in ensuring their mental and emotional wellbeing.

COLLABORATION WITH THE RSCERT (RAJASTHAN STATE COUNCIL FOR EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH AND TRAINING)

Teachers are in the business of inspiring but most of the time their involvement in nonacademic activities takes up too much of their headspace which moves them to feeling uninspired. This pandemic has added up to that challenge in the life of an educator. Also, there is an expectation from teachers to be translators of wellbeing practices in the teaching learning processes but there is no support program that is exclusively for teachers to ensure their own mental and emotional wellbeing. Considering the need, Kshamtalaya has curated a 21 days Self paced mental and emotional wellbeing program - "Hausla", for teachers and educators. This helps create an opportunity to initiate a dialogue around wellbeing in teachers and encourages them not only to offer a more compassionate teaching learning process but also to create a cohort of happy and purposeful teachers.

FACILITATING HAUSLA PROGRAM WITH THE DIET FACULTY OF 33 DISTRICTS AND FACULTY MEMBERS OF RSCERT

Kshamtalaya has collaborated as a training partner with the RSCERT "21 days Hausla program" with 256 DIET faculty members from 33 districts of Rajasthan. The order letter for the same has been released and the program will be starting in the upcoming days.

Hausla is a 21 Days mental wellbeing program which covers three major themes

1. Self Efficacy
2. Emotional Regulation
3. Relationships and Interactions

Each theme is associated with the Personal, Social and System domains, as suggested by Peter Senge's Triple focus.

The Hausla program will also be conducted with 45 RSCERT faculty members on request from Ms. Priyanka Jodhawat, Director, RSCERT who wants to ensure better mental, physical and emotional health of all the RSCERT staff members.

Through our intervention with the DIET and the RSCERT on Hausla, we intend to make wellbeing practices a part of in-service teacher training programs. The experience will create prosumers for integrating elements of well-being in teacher support programs and initiate a dialogue on its importance for all educators and make them feel supported to create an inspiring, meaningful and compassionate environment of teaching and learning.

COLLABORATION TO MAKE INTEGRATED LEARNING, WELLBEING AND ENTREPRENEURIAL MINDSET A PART OF STATE CURRICULUM FRAMEWORK

Along with teacher training programs, Kshamtalaya is also exploring opportunities to be part of state level focus groups in order to integrate elements of wellbeing, integrated learning and entrepreneurial mindset in the state curriculum framework of Rajasthan.

KNOWLEDGE AND TECHNICAL PARTNERS IN DEVELOPMENT OF STATE CURRICULUM FRAMEWORK

Kshamatalaya has participated in the process of development of State Curriculum Framework as an official knowledge and technical partner of RSCERT.

उदयपुर 12-12-2021

राज्य पाठ्यचर्या पर कार्यशाला सम्पन्न

उदयपुर : राज्य शैक्षिक अनुसंधान एवं प्रशिक्षण परिषद ने राज्य पाठ्यचर्या बोर्ड के शिक्षकों को कार्यशाला का आयोजन किया। इस कार्यक्रम का उद्देश्य शिक्षकों को राज्य पाठ्यचर्या के अंशों के बारे में जानकारी देना और उन्हें अपने विषयों में अपडेट करना है। कार्यक्रम का आयोजन उदयपुर में एक बड़े हॉल में किया गया।



NEP 2020 राज्य पाठ्यचर्या रूपरेखा (SCF)

विस्तृत अपडेट



राज्य शैक्षिक अनुसंधान एवं प्रशिक्षण परिषद (एससीईआरटी) ने राज्य पाठ्यचर्या बोर्ड के शिक्षकों को कार्यशाला का आयोजन किया। इस कार्यक्रम का उद्देश्य शिक्षकों को राज्य पाठ्यचर्या के अंशों के बारे में जानकारी देना और उन्हें अपने विषयों में अपडेट करना है।



स्कूल शिक्षा में मानसिक स्वास्थ्य पर जोर देने के लिए एससीईआरटी ने शुरू किया "हौसला कार्यक्रम"



उदयपुर | राज्य शैक्षिक अनुसंधान एवं प्रशिक्षण परिषद (एससीईआरटी) ने "हौसला कार्यक्रम" की शुरुआत गुरुवार के को। परिषद की निदेशक प्रियंका जोधावत ने बताया कि इस 21 दिवसीय कार्यक्रम में प्रदेश की सभी 33 डाइट को शामिल किया गया है। कार्यक्रम आत्मविश्वास, भावनात्मक जागरूकता, नियंत्रण, अंतर निर्भरता और पारस्परिक संबंध पर आधारित है। कार्यक्रम का मुख्य उद्देश्य शिक्षकों, उनके प्रशिक्षकों और अधिकारियों को सकारात्मक, खुश और उद्देश्यपूर्ण होने के लिए अभ्यासों और रणनीतियों के माध्यम से सहयोग करना है। कार्यक्रम के दौरान एसोसिएट प्रो. कमलेंद्र ने बताया कि मानसिक स्वास्थ्य को बेहतर बनाने के लिए सकारात्मक मानसिकता को विकसित करना आवश्यक है, जो अपने संपर्क में आने वाले लोगों में भी सकारात्मक ऊर्जा का संचार करती है। इसमें क्षमतालय फाउंडेशन भी सहयोगी है। इस दौरान संयुक्त निदेशक शिवजी गौड़, असिस्टेंट प्रो. शशिबाला, अंजलि गुप्ते, पूजा सिंह, विवेक कुमार, सौम्या भास्कराचार्या, राहुल रविशंकर और पल्लवी माहेश्वरी आदि मौजूद रहे।



**“The secret in
education lies
in respecting
the student.”**

- RALPH WALDO EMERSON

Teachers



CLASSROOM PRINT RICHNESS

Capacity building and planning sessions mentored by an external expert were facilitated with 11 teachers. The team members worked closely with their teachers in redesigning the classroom spaces to feel welcoming and conducive of meaningful, joyful learning to children. 18 Classroom spaces are print rich as per children curriculum and needs.

TEACHER LEADERSHIP

School vision and plan was created with both the principals. Vision building session was facilitated with 34 teachers, out of which 26 teachers have chosen one vertical to engage deeply with.

- Child Centered Pedagogy: 9 Teachers
- Social Emotional and Ethical Learning: 9 Teachers
- Parental Engagement: 8 Teachers

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL AND ETHICAL LEARNING

A total of 122 sessions were co-facilitated with 9 teachers and 200 children online, sessions were focused on building children's capacities in identifying sensations and emotions, understanding resilient zones and practicing compassion. 2 Workshops on Body and Self Awareness (SEEL) have been facilitated in both schools respectively with a total of 18 teachers as participants. 9 Teacher Cafes-spaces to facilitate peer learning and sharing amongst teachers have been held.

CHILD CENTERED PEDAGOGY

130 sessions have been co-facilitated with teachers which included online demo sessions along with planning and debrief with teacher. Baseline ASER assessment of grade 3,4 and 5 were conducted and learning material to improve children foundational learning were provided to parents as per children learning levels. Reached out directly to 250 children through online classes facilitated with Teachers and 198 parents through Parent Teachers Meeting. To support Teachers Capacity building, 12 Cafes were facilitated on themes chosen by Teacher which included art integration in class, storytelling techniques and more.

PARENTAL ENGAGEMENT

38 PTM's with a total of 8 teachers have been organised with a total of 305 parents (76% of total parents). The objective of these PTM was to strengthen relationships with teachers and help parents to understand how they can play a supportive role in their childrens' education. 155 Parents have more than 60% regular attendance in PTM's. Insights from the baseline-endline with Teachers on Parent Engagement: Teachers reported an average increase of 18-20% parents engagement on a weekly basis. 6 Teachers have shared in the Endline Tool that on an average parent engagement in their class has increased by 50%. Teachers shared that after 2 PTMs, 30% parents have started focusing on their child's learning and also reaching out to teachers for seeking support. Monika Mam was a newly appointed teacher in the school. PTM helped her to connect with parents. She observed a 45% increase in parents engagement in her class.

Community



FAMILY CHAMPIONS PROGRAM

The first cohort of the family champions were a part of a series of 12 engagement sessions - focused on Self Care, COVID and vaccination awareness, strategies to engage children at home in learning. 35 Family champions and community members engaged in Financial Literacy Virtual Volunteering Session: A Pehal CSR Initiative with MIF. 20 Family Champions from the Cohort 2 graduated and started supporting their teachers in PTM and Learning Circles Programme. Average attendance of the cohort in these 17 sessions was 80%. 90% Family Champions reported that they feel more confident while holding conversations with other parents and teachers after the programme. Family Champions Cohort helped 65 out of school children enroll in the school. A session on Menstrual Hygiene and Taboos was facilitated in collaboration with "We the Change" for community leaders. Along with understanding the science of menstruation, the focus was to gain awareness on the taboos we observe and how each one of us can contribute in making a shift for ourselves and our children to shed away the lack of confidence which these taboos burden us with.

SAMVAAD

3 Sessions were organised in collaboration with Haqdarshak where parents were given information about different financial government schemes they could benefit from. Along with this E-Sharm cards were made for eligible parents. A total of 139 parents joined in these sessions.

SCHOOL MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE

A School Management Committee was reconstituted in one school on request of the Principal. 14 training sessions were facilitated with SMC members on their power, roles and responsibilities with an average attendance of 80%. SMC Members have started with their respective school observation roles and reached out to 19 non contact children and enrolled 6 out of school children into school.





Governance



GOOGLE MEET ORIENTATION: TEACHER'S TRAINING SESSION

To train 5000+ Teachers online on behalf of EDMC of 368 schools, on the basic features of Google Meet so that they can take online classes with children post summer vacation. 5293 Teachers participated in the one day online training, 8 Video tutorials were created as resources to support teachers.

ONLINE MEGA PTM

Supported EDMC technically to facilitate an online MEGA PTM on 24 October which was attended by all key officials of EDMC Education Department and reached out to 1.09 lac audience online. The objective of Mega PTM was to share about the department initiatives taken towards online-offline education of children.

BUILDING SCHOOL LEADERSHIP CAPACITY

Sessions have been facilitated with each Leader to build vision, session observation and provide relevant feedback to Teachers. One leader has started actively observing Teachers sessions and providing them with feedback. Both Leaders participated in the Workshops. Also supported the school leader in planning school reopening operations.

Children



VIRTUAL SUMMER CAMP

The summer vacations and the lockdown demanded a response to keep the children engaged in joyful and meaningful learning. Children with access to smart devices were reached out to through WhatsApp groups and Zoom sessions for activity-based learning.

A total of 175 students from classes 3,4 and 5 were engaged, with an average 40% attendance. A total of 5250 responses were received during the 50 day period on the Whatsapp groups.

EXPRESSION & STORYTELLING

A group of 28 children in collaboration with NOT JUST TALES, learnt storytelling techniques and expression and 10 children graduated from the programme and presented their art on an online storytelling festival on Facebook Katha Utsav in October.

LEARNING KITS

For children with/without access to the world wide web, self learning kits were facilitated to the children with the support of teachers and Family Champions. A total of 1116 learning kits were facilitated to the children. Along with 600+ books in the community to continue children engagement with storybooks.

COMMUNITY LIBRARY

To facilitate creative confidence and expression in children through storytelling sessions in community, 8 Community libraries were established in respective different communities where our school children belong to 252 children are part of these libraries and a total of 112 storytelling sessions have been facilitated. 95% children issued storybooks regularly and on an average 65% children expressed the stories. Children of 3 libraries also voluntarily organised a storytelling festival where they enacted plays and stories they have read in books.

MISSION BUNIYAAD MATHS BOOT CAMP

Mission Buniyaad Boot Camp of Maths was facilitated for two weeks for 110 students of Class 5 to strengthen their Foundational Maths Skills before they graduated from the school in March. 100% children reached Multiplication Level and 96% children reached Division skills.

ONLINE COMMUNITY LIBRARY

During COVID lockdown, started two whatsapp groups for online facilitation of stories with 90 children in collaboration with Library Coordinators. A total of 1010 responses were received during the 30 day period on the whatsapp groups.

LEARNING CIRCLES: FOUNDATIONAL LITERACY BASED PROGRAM

15 Learning Circles reaching out to 175 children were launched in the community spaces in December 2021 with support of Family Champions. Objective of the program was to strengthen the foundational literacy and numeracy skills of children in Grades 3-5. 13 Learning Circles and 153 children graduated from the program. The endline assessment showed progress in Mathematics skills by 15% and Hindi language skill by 10%. The progress was achieved by inputs given in a 3 month program (December to March 1 Week)



Our Overall Highlights & Achievements of the year

In July 2021, Kshamtalaya Foundation completed its 5 years. This time period has helped the team reflect, unlearn, relearn and re-imagine education to be able to adapt to the constantly changing ecosystems. The major takeaway has been - that "Together" is the only optimal way of moving forward.

IMPACT OF COLLECTIVE EFFORTS

- Covid Relief Work- During the lethal second wave of covid, when our communities needed us more than ever, we could stand by their side. Conducted 5000+ household surveys with the help of a collaborative network of CSOs working in and around Udaipur and supported 2149 families with humanitarian support. Distributed more than 17000 masks to children, and community members, and engaged with more than 3000 people to educate them about covid appropriate behavior. Along with this, because of the help of our benevolent partners, we could support the District and block functionaries with 800+ pulse oximeters and thermal guns, and 100 oximeters were distributed in Kotda and Gogunda to incident commanders and Covid support task force. In Delhi 640 Ration Kits and 1200 Learning Kits were distributed with the support of Community Champions.
- Expanding accessibility through an IVRS medium- Kshamta Vani turned out to be a medium to increase the accessibility of educational content, information around covid appropriate behavior, wellbeing practices and also to communicate the need, opinions, and best practices and challenges.
- Vegetable seeds were facilitated by Kshamtalaya in the month of July to 100 families in Jhed, Kotda those seeds have now turned into beautiful kitchen gardens taken care of by families and homegrown vegetables are being used for nutritious meals.
- With consistent engagement with teachers, the community, the entire ecosystem, and with the collective efforts of fellows and the system, we could not only bring back 96% of the children to school as soon as they reopened after one and a half years but also out could see a jump in enrollment 2024 to 2316 children in 3rd to 5th Grade.

- Out of 1903 samples, 67% of our children showed improvement in their Hindi reading ability and 65% showed improvement in their foundational numeracy from baseline to end line. Along with this, with all the fluctuations in children's presence, we have been able to collect the common sample of 1690 children for life skills improvement and found that around 44% of children have shown improvement in their life skills such as communicating their feelings, perspective-taking, and also listening to others.

RECOGNITION AND ACHIEVEMENTS

- GSSS Mandwa, Kotda, Rajasthan received a prestigious recognition of being among the top 100 schools in the world in T4 World education week.
- Hausla, a 21 day well-being program for Teachers, Educators and Adults was launched in collaboration with BRIO and was also selected as one of the global solutions as part of the OpenIDEO challenge.
- Two of the leadership team members, Vivek Kumar and Pooja Singh became certified CBCT facilitators by the Center of Contemplative Science and Compassion-based ethics, Emory University.
- Amrit and Radha, two of the idiscover fellows were felicitated on 15th August by the block level Government functionaries for their exceptional contribution in supporting children's learning during the pandemic and standing with the community during difficult times.
- Kshamtalaya's efforts were recognized by the schools we are currently supporting and the team members were felicitated on annual functions and Republic day.
- Abhishek, from the leadership team, completed a course named Foundation of Education, offered by Digantar and sponsored by Wipro Foundation, an immersive experience to understand the sociological, philosophical and epistemological perspective on education and learned about the intricacies of Action Based Research.
- Abhishek also completed a Certificate Program in Instructional Design offered by I Am A Teacher sponsored by Wipro Foundation.

- Pooja and Rahul, members of the leadership team completed their SEE Learning LI Facilitator certification, offered by SEE Learning India and Emory University.
- Kshamtalaya was selected as one of the finalists for the 9th National Conference on Social Innovation 2021 organized by Pune International Center, an independent think tank that deliberates on issues of national importance. Although our organization did not win the conference in the Tribal category, we have been offered a year-long mentorship by experts from the think tank.
- Nisha Kothari, Anchor Team Member and Operations lead of Fale Fale Shiksha Muheem program is the cohort member of "The UPAI-Kickoff Women Leaders Fellowship" which is a collaboration between the UPAI's Development Committee and Kickoff Solutions to support young girls/women in the age group of 15 to 20, with leadership potential that are contributing towards improving the lives of their fellow community members. The Fellowship will provide opportunities for development of leadership skills including workshops and mentorship, along with financial support for candidates with demonstrable need.
- Asif Khan, a Diganth Project facilitator in Government Senior Secondary school Jhed, Kotra was selected for a winter school program of 9 days at Koombara, Kerala. This is a leadership training program, in which 14 changemakers across India came together. It was designed to learn more skills around leadership, community engagement, advocacy, youth development and educational practices.
- Shashidhar Sa, anchor team member attended the Edelgive x X-leaps capacity building program which was focussed on problem solving skills, creative thinking, effective communication and teamwork. There were about 12 members in the cohort across India.
- Tina Aggarawal and Pallavi completed 'An Introduction to Libraries Course' offered by Bookworm and completed their project works by exploring and engaging with different library activities.
- Tina Aggarwal was selected for the CHILD course on Inclusive Education by Aatman Educational Society. This CERTIFICATE course in HOLISTIC INCLUSION of LEARNERS with DIVERSITIES is specially designed for in-service educators, practicing counselors, graduate students or members of the community supporting children's educational needs.

- Anjali Gupte, one of the Anchor Team Members joined an International Level group known as Build Math Mind led by Christina Tondevold and attended a Virtual Summit as well. She is also connected through the websites and keeps doing mini courses related to different capabilities around Maths concepts.

EXPANDING THE IMPACT AND REACH WITH GOVERNMENT PARTNERSHIPS

- Kshamtalaya entered into an MOU with Rajasthan State Council for Education Research and Training until 2025. Kshamtalaya is one of the knowledge and technical support partners for the development of the state curriculum framework where 5 members are closely involved in creation of position papers and 4 SCF frameworks - school education, adult education, ECCE and Teacher Education. Kshamtalaya is also a technical partner in supporting the state in this mission. Kshamtalaya is one of 13 partner organizations in this journey of implementing the guidelines of NEP 2020.
- With RSCERT, Kshamtalaya has also been onboarded as a supporting partner for the Assessment cell to bring about a holistic assessment reform at the systemic level.
- Kshamtalaya has supported RSCERT in Communication and Collaterals creation that has resulted in really bringing the space to life. Coordinating with each division's achievements and visualizing that into the walls and corridors to amplify the efforts that RSCERT has been taking this year. This has been appreciated by the Director at RSCERT.
- Vivek Kumar and Soumya facilitated 'How Children Learn' workshop for about 20 ECCE teachers that was initiated by Division 1 of RSCERT. The workshop was well received by the teachers which was designed in an experiential format that evoked meaningful reflections from them.
- Kshamtalaya is also in the process of signing the agreement with the Rajasthan Council for School Education to work with 250 schools on wellbeing and integrated learning.
- Kshamtalaya in collaboration with RSCERT has been able to facilitate Hausla, a mental and emotional wellbeing program with more than 200 DIET faculty members of 29 DIETs, and received so much love, appreciation and support from the participants and RSCERT.

- Kshamtalaya also completed Hausla program with 50 teachers of Jhadol and Phalasiya, in August- September which started with a partnership with block education officers of both the blocks and with the responses of Pre-post-assessment of Hausla, we found that the program shows statistical improvement in Emotional Awareness and regulation of people.
- In May 2021, Kshamtalaya, in collaboration with the education department of EDMC, supported by 5 volunteers, facilitated a virtual training session on "Using Google Meet for online learning". The program which spanned over a week, witnessed the participation of 5000+ teachers.
- EDMC facilitated an online Mega PTM in the month of October. This was supported by Kshamtalaya as a technical partner. The PTM reached out to 1.25 lakh parents through Google meet and youtube platforms.
- Kshamtalaya contributed to the module development on Digital Learning, Class Management, Social Emotional and Ethical Learning, for Diksha Platform under the Teacher Need Analysis project led by division 3- Teacher Training and Development Division of RSCERT. The module will reach to 4 Lakhs+ teachers and support them in their Professional Development.
- Kshamtalaya organized a capacity building session for 80 teachers of Gogunda Block on implementing Innovative pedagogies within a classroom environment. The Cluster Block Education Officer reached out to us and program manager Naushad Baig Mirza and fellow Hadisha implemented the session.

PARTNERSHIP AND ORGANIZATIONAL COLLABORATION WITH CSOS

- Kshamtalaya has been able to cultivate partners such as BRIO, Bain Consultancy, JP Morgans, and Gratitude scale network, who have been providing their pro bono support through strengthening organizational systems, tech integration, building scaling strategies, Capacity building of team members.
- Kshamtalaya has also partnered with Jatan Sansthan, Bhumi, Action-Aid to extend our impact and reach to their partners through capacity building and our content programs like Integrated Audio Learning Programs, Picture Books, Hausla etc.

- On 26 February 2022, Haqdarshak facilitated a Samvaad with 153 community members at the Nagar Nigam Pratibha Vidyalaya, F Block, Dilshad Colony, East Delhi in collaboration with Kshamtalaya. The objective was to support the participants in availing information on bank account processes, life insurances and government schemes which the community could benefit from.
- Hausla has been translated into English and Tamil by Bhumi Organisation who also completed Hausla and had taken facilitator training on the program to facilitate it to their partners.
- Pooja Singh, anchor team member and Learning & Growth team lead facilitated 'Getting Started with SEE Learning' with our partner SEE Learning India for Spiti Government School teachers.
- Pooja Singh and Vivek Kumar together led 6 workshops for WCD, Delhi Government in partnership with Indus Action. The theme of the workshop was emotions and expressions.
- Divyesh Joshi and Soumya, anchor team members of Kshamtalaya were invited to facilitate a reflective and experiential workshop on 'What is Learning' for about 25 India Fellows during their month long induction program held in Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Udaipur.
- Abhilasha Sachan facilitated a session on 'prevention of Child Sexual Abuse' with a cohort of 50+ adolescent girls of Spreading Smiles initiative of BG Foundation.

EXPANDING HORIZONS THROUGH LEARNING PLATFORMS

- Taking a step forward from last year, this year children from Kotda - Kishan and Dinesh, primary graders from Kukawas school, and Delhi schools' children Ankita and Nandini became panelists at the national level conference of SEE learning organized by Tech Mahindra Foundation. were also the panelists.
- As part of the annual review and consolidation process, the team had put up an exhibition to share the stories of resilience, creations, and explorations they experienced throughout the year with our communities, teachers and children. The efforts were wholeheartedly appreciated by CSOs and govt. Functionaries in Rajasthan. More than 50 children from Govt. Hostels visited and enjoyed the experiential sessions. In Delhi more than 200 parents and children attended the exhibition along with SMC members.

- Motilal, facilitator Diganth Project and Joshila iDISCOVER fellow were selected to attend a capacity building program on Menstrual Hygiene Management by Jatan Sansthan. This opportunity helped them to understand the nuances around menstruation, role of men in menstruation and how to create a more acceptable society to help normalize menstruation in communities.
- Kshamtalaya was invited to host a stall in sharing their learning and challenges on field in the much awaited Milan Mela organized by Kotda Adivasi Sansthan. It is a mega level celebration and community driven event which is attended by District collectors to hear the efforts Kotra's communities are taking each day in livelihoods, education and agriculture initiatives.
- Not Just Tales Organisation collaborated and facilitated online storytelling capacity building sessions with 20 children from EDMC Nigam Balika Pratibha School, Delhi which culminated with children presenting their storytelling skills on an online storytelling platform with Not Just Tales Katha Utsav on Facebook.
- In collaboration with We the Change Foundation, co facilitated a session on Menstrual Health and Hygiene with 30+ mothers of EDMC Nigam Balika Pratibha School, Delhi.

A GLIMPSE OF REGIONAL LEADERSHIP

- Joshila, one of the local Idiscover fellows coached led a Frisbee tournament in Kotda, with 6 teams participating from 3 panchayats where more than 100 children attended the process. The entire process was supported through crowdfunding and community support.
- Ashok, another Idiscover fellow has been selected as a govt. Elementary level teacher and will be serving his community by bringing purpose and innovative practices to teaching-learning experiences.
- In Gogunda, Kshamta Sathis and the Program team of Fale Fale Shiksha Muheem organized a friendly frisbee tournament with the support of crowdfunding and community resources.

SOLVING THE SYSTEMIC ISSUE OF POOR GOVERNANCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY OF TEACHERS

- The challenge of poor governance in the functioning of schools as per their scheduled time due to the lack of any process to ensure the accountability of teachers was addressed by the community in GPS Kharon ki Khejdi and GPS Degrifala when the fellow took a step to engage with different stakeholders to establish this as a pertinent issue for communities to engage with to solve this problem that further leads to more sustainable impact.
- SMC members of GUPS Anjani, and Kotra donated their land to the school after understanding the need for space for children to learn and also collected money to arrange for floor mats for children.
- Kshamtalaya was invited to be a part of Jan Samvaad on Children Rights and Protection organized by Kailash Satyarthi Foundation and Kotda Adivasi Sansthan where the need to strengthen the governance structure was kept forward to DM, SDM, and to the representative of Child Protection Committee.

Acknowledgement

Our heartfelt gratitude goes out to our partners, supporters, friends and family for their love, trust, and guidance in making it possible for us to give our dedicated energies on the ground operations.

At times, our own light goes out and is rekindled by a spark from another person. Each of us has a cause to think with deep gratitude of those who have lit the flame within us - the dedication, passion with which the communities and the local governance of Kotra, Gogunda and East Delhi who believed and invested their time and energies in us, inspiring us to stay true to our purpose and cause.

Kshamtalaya also extends their gratitude to all the volunteers, Learning Festival facilitators who added their energies and motivation along the way, without whom, it would have not been possible to reach out to 9000+ children. And we thank each one of our children and their parents for loving us, trusting us and motivating us to always go the extra mile.

We also extend love, compassion and a lot of gratitude to the District Collector (Udaipur), SDMs, CBEEO, BDO, ACBO, PEEO, Pradhan, Sarpanch, Wardpanch and Secretaries of Kotra and Gogunda blocks; Additional Directory, Deputy Director, School Inspectors of EDMC, Delhi; all the Press and Media representatives.

We look forward to continuing this journey of helping children realize their true potential by ensuring that they attain quality education.

THANK YOU!

